3.3 Spanish Missions in Texas

4th Grade Social Studies · Video: Spanish Missions in Texas (Studies Weekly)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Why Spain Built Missions

In _____, both France and Spain wanted the area now known as Texas.

The Spanish built missions to keep the _____ from moving in from the east.

Missions were also built to teach _____ and the Spanish way of life to the American Indian tribes who lived there.

Life at the Missions

Franciscan priests, also called _____, taught the beliefs of the Roman Catholic Church.

The friars built _____ and places to live.

They taught local American Indians how to grow gardens and _____.

They also taught the skills of _____, weaving, masonry, and carpentry.

Spain built at least _____ missions in the Texas region over time.

The goal was to bring American Indians into Spanish _____ and to colonize the area.

What Happened to the Missions

The new _____ helped build the economy and shape the Spanish American frontier.

Many American Indians did not want mission life and kept fighting the Spanish.

The missions in the _____ failed to keep the French from moving into the area.

In the end, most missions were _____, and many are now ruins.

Some missions still hold _____ today.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
mission	a settlement where priests taught their religion and a way of life
friar	a Franciscan priest who worked at a mission
trade	a job that uses special skills, like weaving or carpentry
abandoned	left behind and no longer used

Key Takeaways

• Spain built missions in Texas to keep the French out and to teach the Catholic faith and Spanish ways.

• Friars taught farming and trades like blacksmithing, weaving, masonry, and carpentry.

• Most missions were later abandoned, but their impact on Texas is still felt today.